

Stepping into the big league

Not afraid to make sacrifices, Kriish Tyagi is ready for bigger challenges as he navigates a **crucial transition** point in his career.

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Kriish Tyagi, India's top-ranked junior player, is No. 44 on the ITF World Junior Tennis Tour and has seven singles titles to his name. But having turned 18 in April, he is now in his final year competing as a junior. The young player from Sarjapur, Bengaluru, now finds himself at a defining crossroads — where the river of junior tennis meets the vast, uncharted ocean of the senior circuit.

While a strong finish in his final showing at the Junior Grand Slams remains important, Kriish isn't afraid to make sacrifices for the bigger picture — which is why, after completing his Class 12 exams last month and facing limited clay-court training options in India, he and coach Harsha Lingappa chose to skip the French Open this year.

"The quality of clay courts in Europe is something you don't get in India. I don't feel my game is ready for that kind of clay. It's just tough to get a hang of it when you go for tournaments," Kriish told *Sportstar*.

He is, however, looking forward to Wimbledon and the US Open. "Playing on grass



Looking to build his ATP ranking, Kriish has also been adding more Futures events to his calendar — a move that's already showing results.